

BERNARD SAMUEL EKPOTO

Software Engineer | Backend Engineer | PHP/Laravel | Python

Lagos, Nigeria | Open to International Opportunities & Relocation

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LinkedIn: [Click](#) | GitHub: [Click](#) | Portfolio: [Click](#)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software Engineer and Backend Engineer with **5 years of professional experience** designing, developing, integrating, and deploying production software using **PHP/Laravel and Python**. Experienced in building RESTful APIs, financial technology platforms, identity verification systems, invoicing applications, payment integrations, and SaaS solutions.

Strong expertise in **Laravel, PHP, Python, FastAPI, Django, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Docker, Linux, Nginx, AWS, DigitalOcean, Git, and third-party API integrations**. Experienced in database design, backend architecture, authentication, webhooks, payment processing, scheduled jobs, data processing, and production troubleshooting.

Hands-on experience across **FinTech, identity verification, KYC/KYB, e-commerce, invoicing, research, and startup environments**. Comfortable collaborating with frontend engineers, UI/UX designers, product teams, and technical stakeholders to deliver reliable and maintainable software.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: PHP, Python, JavaScript, SQL, HTML, CSS

Backend: Laravel, FastAPI, Django, REST APIs, MVC, API Architecture, Authentication, Authorization, Webhooks

Databases: MySQL, PostgreSQL, SQLite, Supabase

DevOps & Cloud: Docker, Docker Compose, Linux, Ubuntu, Nginx, AWS EC2, DigitalOcean

Frontend: JavaScript, jQuery, Bootstrap, Tailwind CSS, Blade, DataTables

Integrations: Paystack, BudPay, Providus APIs, Twilio, Vonage, third-party REST APIs

Development: Git, GitHub, Composer, npm, API Testing, Database Migrations, Query Optimization

Specialised: KYC/KYB, Identity Verification, Document Processing, Liveness Detection, Face Verification, Payment Systems

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

HEAD OF IT

Datapro — Nigeria

January 2026 – Present

- Lead the planning, development, implementation, and maintenance of software and IT systems supporting business operations.
 - Provide technical leadership across software engineering, backend development, infrastructure, application support, and technology initiatives.
 - Design, develop, and maintain production applications and APIs using **PHP/Laravel and Python**.
 - Lead backend development for financial, business, identity verification, invoicing, and customer-facing systems.
 - Design and maintain RESTful APIs, database architectures, authentication systems, business workflows, and third-party integrations.
 - Oversee integrations with payment providers, financial institutions, identity verification services, communication platforms, and other external APIs.
 - Develop and maintain payment processing, transaction verification, webhook, billing, and scheduled-payment workflows.
 - Lead **KYC/KYB, customer verification, document processing, liveness detection, and identity verification** solutions.
 - Work with **Python, FastAPI, and computer vision technologies** to support identity and facial verification workflows.
 - Manage application deployment and infrastructure using **Docker, Linux/Ubuntu, Nginx, AWS EC2, and DigitalOcean**.
 - Troubleshoot production incidents, investigate application and infrastructure failures, analyze logs, and implement technical solutions.
 - Oversee database design, migrations, query optimization, data processing, and application performance improvements using **MySQL and PostgreSQL**.
 - Collaborate with developers, frontend engineers, UI/UX designers, business stakeholders, and management to translate requirements into technical solutions.
 - Provide technical guidance and contribute to technology strategy, architecture, automation, and continuous improvement.
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SOFTWARE DEVELOPER / BACKEND ENGINEER

D'Accubin — Nigeria

June 2023 – January 2026

- Developed backend applications and RESTful APIs using **PHP, Laravel, MySQL, and JavaScript**.

- Implemented controllers, models, middleware, validation, database relationships, and business workflows.
 - Built customer management, document processing, verification, reporting, and business automation functionality.
 - Integrated third-party APIs and developed communication workflows between internal and external systems.
 - Implemented server-side pagination and optimized database queries for data-intensive applications.
 - Developed CSV and data-processing workflows for business operations.
 - Participated in application testing, debugging, deployment, maintenance, and production support.
 - Collaborated with other developers and stakeholders to implement new features and resolve technical issues.
 - Used Git-based development workflows for source-code management and feature delivery.
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SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Krosai (formerly Moosbu) — Nigeria

March 2023 – January 2025

- Worked as a Software Engineer across **FinTech and AI startup products**, contributing to the development of production software.
 - Developed backend services and RESTful APIs using **PHP/Laravel and Python**.
 - Designed and implemented database structures, business logic, authentication, API endpoints, and application workflows.
 - Contributed to **FinTech solutions**, including financial workflows, transaction processing, payment integrations, and business automation.
 - Worked on **AI-focused products**, contributing to backend services and integrations supporting artificial intelligence and computer vision use cases.
 - Developed and integrated third-party APIs for payments, identity verification, communication, and other platform services.
 - Worked with **Python, FastAPI, and computer vision technologies** for AI-related application functionality.
 - Contributed to identity verification and facial verification workflows, including similarity comparison and verification logic.
 - Built and maintained webhook integrations for external services and payment providers.
 - Worked with **MySQL, PostgreSQL, Docker, Git, and Linux-based environments**.
 - Collaborated with product teams, frontend developers, designers, and engineers in a fast-paced startup environment.
 - Participated in testing, debugging, deployment, production support, and continuous improvement.
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SOFTWARE ENGINEER / BACKEND ENGINEER

E-Devs Solution — Nigeria

January 2022

- Developed and maintained backend applications using **PHP, Laravel, Python, FastAPI, and Django**.
 - Built RESTful APIs supporting web applications, mobile applications, and external integrations.
 - Designed database models, relationships, migrations, queries, and business logic using **MySQL and PostgreSQL**.
 - Developed financial, customer management, identity verification, invoicing, and business automation solutions.
 - Implemented authentication, authorization, validation, middleware, rate limiting, and API security mechanisms.
 - Integrated payment, identity verification, communication, and other third-party APIs.
 - Implemented webhook processing and signature verification for external services.
 - Developed scheduled jobs and automated workflows for recurring business processes.
 - Worked with Docker and Linux-based environments for application deployment and troubleshooting.
 - Collaborated with frontend developers and UI/UX designers to deliver application features.
 - Investigated production issues, optimized database queries, and implemented application improvements.
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SELECTED PROJECTS

Financial & Fund Management Platform

PHP | Laravel | MySQL | JavaScript | DataTables

- Developed backend functionality for financial management and fund manager workflows.
- Implemented account scoring, reporting, customer/account management, and data retrieval APIs.
- Built database-driven business processes and optimized queries for application performance.
- Supported ongoing improvements based on changing business and regulatory requirements.

Identity Verification & KYC Platform

PHP | Laravel | Python | FastAPI | MySQL | Docker

- Developed backend workflows for customer identity verification and document processing.
- Implemented APIs for managing verification requests, customer records, documents, and verification results.
- Worked with liveness detection and facial verification functionality.
- Designed verification workflows with consideration for sensitive customer data handling.

Payment & Billing Integrations

Laravel | PHP | Python | FastAPI | Paystack | BudPay | Providus

- Integrated multiple payment providers into backend applications.
- Implemented payment verification and webhook-processing workflows.
- Implemented cryptographic signature verification for incoming webhook requests.
- Developed scheduled payment processing and transaction aggregation functionality.
- Investigated API connectivity, timeout, and integration failures in production environments.

Electronic Invoicing & Tax Platform

Laravel | PHP | MySQL | PostgreSQL | Docker | Nginx

- Developed backend functionality for electronic invoicing and taxpayer-related workflows.
- Implemented invoice, supplier, transaction, and due-date management functionality.
- Worked on PDF invoice generation and QR-code integration.
- Supported database migrations, production deployment, and Linux/Docker troubleshooting.

AI / Computer Vision & Face Verification

Python | Computer Vision | FastAPI

- Worked with facial embeddings and similarity comparison for identity verification.
- Implemented similarity scoring using facial embedding distance.
- Developed backend logic for verification decisions and confidence scoring.
- Integrated machine-learning-based verification capabilities into backend workflows.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering (B.Eng.), Mechanical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

Python Programming Certification — Pirple

Certificate of Appreciation — Student Community — ShapeAI

Professional Soft Skills Certification — Jobberman

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Career Focus: Software Engineering, Backend Engineering, API Development, FinTech, SaaS, Cloud Applications, AI/Computer Vision

Core Strengths: Backend Architecture, API Development, Database Design, Problem Solving, System Integration, Production Troubleshooting, Technical Collaboration

Availability: Open to international employment opportunities and relocation.

References: Available upon request.